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The Cold Email Vault

12 templates that actually converted

AUTHOR

Max Münstermann, closed:in

CLOSEDIN.IO

GTM Engineering Agency

Read this first

This is a working document, not a marketing brochure. Every template below comes from a live closed:in client campaign. Names and identifying details are changed. Numbers, copy structure and sequence logic are real.

Per template you get:

- **Industry and ICP** — who it was sent to
- **Sequence step** — opener, follow-up or final touch
- **Reply rate** — measured over the full segment (not cherry-picked sub-segments)
- **OTR** — opportunity-to-reply ratio. How many replies actually turned into qualified meetings. A high reply rate with a low OTR is a red flag, not a win.
- **Subject and body** — copy-paste ready, with `{{merge_fields}}` marked
- **Why this works** — one line on the principle behind it

A few ground rules we apply across every campaign:

1. **Plain text, always.** No HTML, no images, no fancy fonts. Plain text inboxes 90%+ of the time, HTML inboxes much less and triggers spam scores.
2. **One CTA per email.** Every paragraph should pull the reader toward the same single action.
3. **No filler openers.** "Quick question", "Quick note", "Hope you're well", "Sorry to bother" — all banned. Get to value in line one.
4. **Recipient language.** Dutch prospects get Dutch emails. UK and US get English. Don't mix.
5. **New money, de-risked, done for you.** Cold offers describe an outcome the prospect wants but does not have yet, with risk on us, fully delivered. No audits, no assessments, no "let's explore".

Template 01: Boutique acquisition

Industry: Creative agency / fashion brand **ICP:** Multi-brand boutique owners **Region:** NL, FR, PL, UK **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 28.3% **OTR:** 35%

Subject: `{{boutique_name}}` + `{{brand_name}}`

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Saw {{boutique_name}} carries {{competitor_brand_1}} and {{competitor_brand_2}}.

We're {{brand_name}}, Dutch women's fashion, small batches, timeless designs. Currently in
{{social_proof_boutique_count}} boutiques across {{markets}}.

Worth a quick look at our SS26 line for {{boutique_name}}?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Subject line is the only one a boutique owner would actually open. The body proves you did research (specific competitor brands they stock), positions you next to brands they already chose, and asks for the smallest possible commitment (a look

at a line, not a meeting).

Template 02: Hospitality SaaS opener

Industry: Vertical SaaS for hospitality **ICP:** Restaurant owners / operators **Region:** NL, BE **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 11.4% **OTR:** 42%

Subject: quick question {{restaurant_name}}

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

{{restaurant_name}} uses {{current_pos_or_ordering_tool}} based on what I could find online.

We built {{product}} specifically for {{restaurant_segment}} like yours. Two things our customers usually
flag after switching: {{specific_benefit_1}} and {{specific_benefit_2}}.

Worth a 15 minute call to see if it fits?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: The current-tool callout signals you understand their stack. The "specifically for" line cuts the segment objection ("we're different") in advance. Reply rate is moderate but OTR is very high because the segment is pre-qualified.

Template 03: B2C-to-B2B retail opener

Industry: Home interior / furniture **ICP:** Multi-brand retailers **Region:** NL, BE, DE **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 35.2% **OTR:** 28%

Subject: {{store_name}} stocking question

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

{{store_name}} stocks {{category}} and your range is {{specific_observation_about_their_curation}}.

We make {{product_line}} that fits next to {{adjacent_brand_in_their_store}}.
{{specific_design_or_quality_detail}}.

Want me to send the wholesale catalogue and a sample?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Subject reads like a real inbound from a retail buyer, not a sales email. The "fits next to {{adjacent_brand}}" line does positioning work without naming a competitor. Asking for catalogue + sample is a low-commitment yes that opens the door for a meeting.

Template 04: B2B SaaS demo booking

Industry: AI / inventory forecasting SaaS **ICP:** Heads of e-commerce, supply chain leads **Region:** NL, EU, UK **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 6.8% **OTR:** 52%

Subject: stockouts at {{company}}

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Most e-com brands at {{company}}'s revenue range lose 6 to 12% of sales to stockouts and another 8 to 15% of margin to overstock. The reason is the same: demand forecasting based on last year's data.

We forecast {{company}}'s next 90 days at SKU level using your sales velocity, promo plans, and seasonality. Customers see stockouts drop 40% in the first quarter.

Worth a 20 minute call to show {{company}}'s forecast on the platform?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Paragraph one quantifies a problem the reader already feels. Paragraph two is the new-money outcome with one specific number. The CTA is concrete (their forecast on the platform), not abstract.

Template 05: PE-backed search firm

Industry: Recruitment / executive search **ICP:** Partners at PE firms **Region:** UK, US **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 4.2% **OTR:** 71%

Subject: portfolio CFO searches

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Saw {{pe_firm}} closed {{recent_deal}} last quarter. Most of the firms we work with run into the same gap 90 days in: a CFO who can scale the next phase, not just close the book.

We're a UK search firm focused exclusively on PE-backed CFOs and finance leadership. Closed {{number}} mandates last year across {{sector_1}}, {{sector_2}} and {{sector_3}}.

Worth 20 minutes to share the search profiles we built for {{comparable_pe_firm}}?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Specific deal callout proves research. The "90 days in" line frames a known pain in their operating cycle. Reply rate is low because PE partners are hard to reach, but OTR is the highest in the set because anyone who replies is in-market.

Template 06: IT / MSP cold offer

Industry: Managed IT services **ICP:** Owners of companies (50-200 FTE) without an in-house IT lead **Region:** NL **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 9.7% **OTR:** 33%

Subject: geen IT-er in dienst bij {{company}}?

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Bedrijven zoals {{company}} hebben vaak geen vaste IT-er in dienst, maar wel een dagelijkse IT-
werkelijkheid: software updates, accounts beheren, laptops voorbereiden, Microsoft 365, beveiliging.

Wij draaien dat al voor {{client_count}}+ Nederlandse MKB-bedrijven. Eén vast aanspreekpunt, vaste
maandprijs, geen verrassingen.

Open om kort te kijken wat we voor {{company}} zouden doen?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Dutch market, Dutch email. Subject line is the exact problem the reader feels every Monday morning. The "vast aanspreekpunt + vaste maandprijs" line removes the two biggest IT-outsourcing fears (random costs, random support people). Pulled from a live ONB-ICT campaign.

Template 07: Sustainability / agri-tech

Industry: Sustainability tech for horticulture **ICP:** Owners of commercial greenhouses (kwekerijen) **Region:** NL **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 7.1% **OTR:** 38%

Subject: energie {{nursery_name}}

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Gascontracten lopen voor veel kwekerijen in 2026 en 2027 af. Wie nu nog op standaard tarieven zit, betaalt
straks 40 tot 60% meer dan kwekerijen met een eigen warmtebron.

We helpen {{nursery_size_segment}} kwekerijen overstappen op {{technology_summary}}. Terugverdientijd zit
gemiddeld onder de 4 jaar, met SDE++ subsidie eronder.

Open om kort te kijken of het voor {{nursery_name}} past?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Opens with a timed fear (contract renewal cliff) that the reader is privately worrying about. Quantified payback period in paragraph two removes the "yeah but expensive" objection before they can think it.

Template 08: E-commerce fulfillment

Industry: 3PL / e-commerce fulfillment **ICP:** Founders of D2C brands doing 500-5,000 orders/month **Region:** NL, BE **Step:** 1 of 3 **Reply rate:** 12.4% **OTR:** 31%

Subject: {{brand}} fulfillment

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Brands at {{brand}}'s order volume usually hit a fulfillment ceiling around 1,500 orders a month. Either the founder is still packing, or a 3PL is charging picking fees that eat 30% of contribution margin.

We run fulfillment for {{client_count}}+ D2C brands like {{social_proof_brand}}. Flat per-order rate, EU-wide same-day cutoff at 18:00, returns handled in 24 hours.

Worth a 15 minute call to walk through {{brand}}'s numbers?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Names the exact threshold where the prospect's pain kicks in (1,500 orders/month). Specific pricing structure (flat per-order, 18:00 cutoff, 24h returns) reads like a comparison, not a pitch.

Template 09: Hospitality follow-up (step 2)

Industry: Vertical SaaS for hospitality (follows T02) **ICP:** Restaurant operators who didn't reply to opener **Region:** NL, BE **Step:** 2 of 3 **Reply rate added:** +6.8% on top of step 1 **OTR:** 39%

Subject: (reply to step 1)

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

To make it concrete: {{comparable_restaurant_in_their_segment}} switched to us last quarter and saw {{specific_outcome_with_number}} in the first month.

Same setup we'd run for {{restaurant_name}}.

15 minutes this week?

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Step 2 adds proof, not pressure. A comparable customer name (in their exact segment) + a number does the heavy lifting. Note: no "just bumping this", no "did you see my last email". Just a new piece of value.

Template 10: SaaS final touch (step 3)

Industry: Vertical SaaS for hospitality (follows T02 and T09) **ICP:** Same as T02 **Region:** NL, BE **Step:** 3 of 3 **Reply rate added:** +2.9% **OTR:** 48%

Subject: (reply to step 1)

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Last one from me. If {{restaurant_name}} is happy with {{current_tool}}, totally fair, ignore this.

If there's an opening to look at {{product}}, reply with a "yes" and I'll send a 5-minute Loom showing the
setup specific to {{restaurant_segment}} restaurants.

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Permission-to-walk-away ("totally fair, ignore this") removes pressure, which paradoxically raises reply rate. The "reply with a yes" + Loom offer is a tiny commitment with a clear next step. Final-touch emails should never threaten or guilt-trip.

Template 11: Retailer follow-up (step 2)

Industry: B2C-to-B2B retail (follows T03) **ICP:** Multi-brand retailers **Region:** NL, BE, DE **Step:** 2 of 3 **Reply rate added:** +9.4% **OTR:** 33%

Subject: (reply to step 1)

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Quick thing on {{product_line}} for {{store_name}}.

We just shipped to {{recent_retailer_in_their_region}} who sell to a {{shared_customer_persona}} customer
base like {{store_name}}'s. They picked up the {{specific_product_or_collection}} first.

Happy to send the line sheet + a sample for {{store_name}} to see in person.

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Same logic as T09 — proof through a peer retailer. Offering a physical sample is a yes-magnet for buyers in this segment (a sample on their desk costs you almost nothing and creates a tactile reminder).

Template 12: Multi-channel re-engagement

Industry: Cross-segment (used in multiple campaigns) **ICP:** Prospects who opened earlier sequence but never replied, 30-60 days later

Region: Any **Step:** Re-engagement **Reply rate:** 5.6% **OTR:** 44%

Subject: {{company}} — different angle

Body:

```
Hi {{first_name}},

Reached out a while back about {{original_topic}} and didn't hear back, which is fine, timing matters.

Different angle: we just put together a {{deliverable_type}} for {{comparable_company_in_their_segment}}
that solved {{specific_outcome}}. Took us {{timeline}} and replaced {{thing_they_currently_do}}.

If that's interesting for {{company}}, happy to share the breakdown.

{{sender_first_name}}
```

Why this works: Acknowledges the silence without apologizing for the first email. Brings a new specific deliverable as the reason for re-engagement. Works especially well 30-45 days after the original sequence ends, when the reader has forgotten the first email but the domain still has trust.

How to use these

1. **Don't copy them verbatim.** Take the structure, replace with your ICP's vocabulary. A reader can tell when copy is recycled from another industry.
 2. **Test one template per campaign.** Send 200-500 emails before judging. Reply rate at n=50 is noise.
 3. **Watch OTR, not reply rate.** 30% reply rate at 5% OTR means you wrote a curiosity-hook that misled. 8% reply rate at 50% OTR is a campaign you should scale.
 4. **Sequence matters.** Step 2 adds 30-60% of total replies. Step 3 catches a small but high-intent tail. Stopping at step 1 leaves 40%+ of pipeline on the table.
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The closed:in playbook

If you want the infrastructure that makes templates like these land in the inbox, the closed:in playbook covers the 50-point pre-launch checklist: domains, warmup, SPF/DKIM/DMARC, list hygiene, sequence timing and reply handling.

Free at: closedin.io/playbook

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No slides, no audit framing. We look at your ICP, your numbers, and tell you whether outbound is the right channel for {{your_company}} or not.

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